

Chapter 4 — Group 4

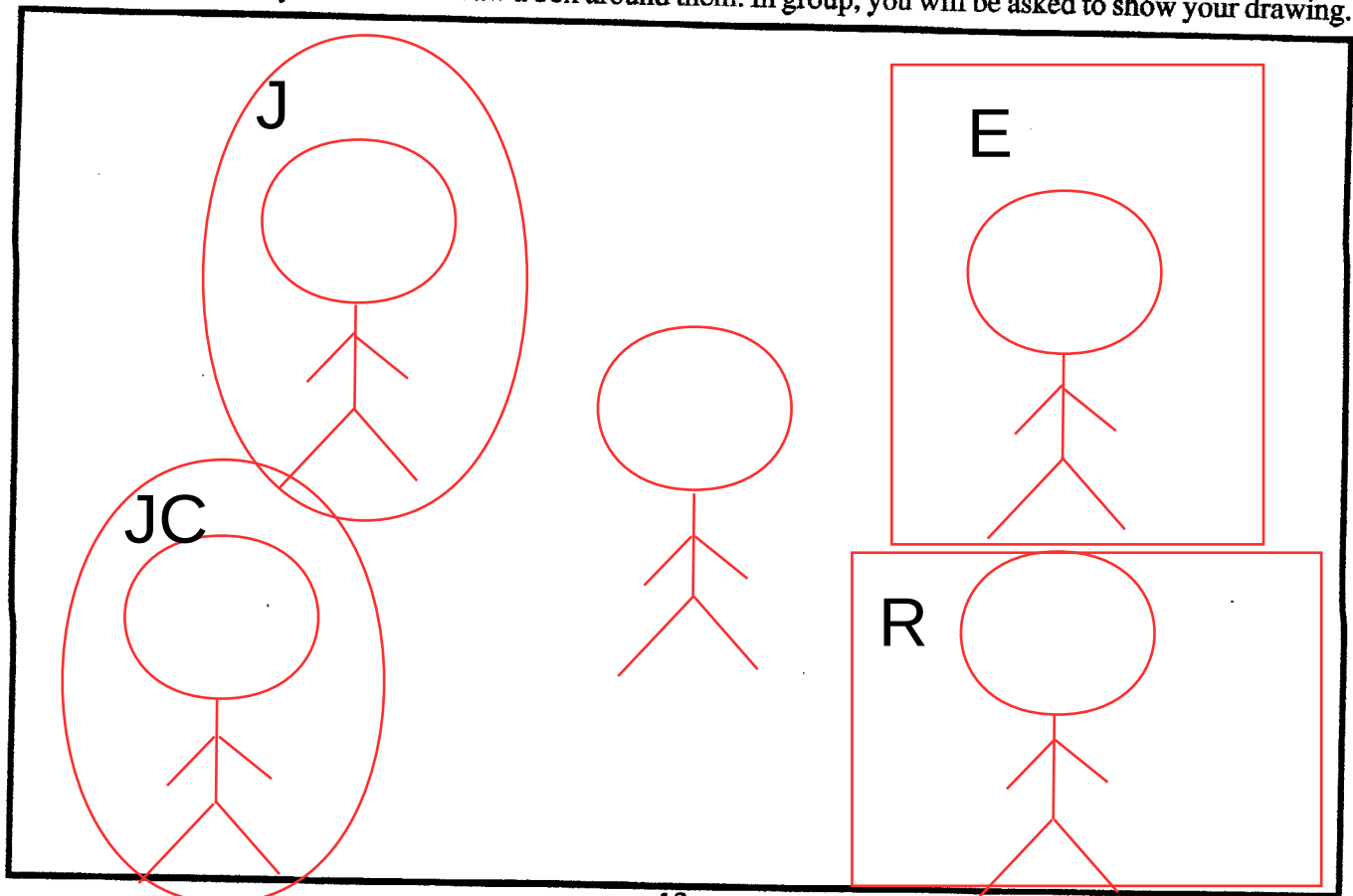
CODEPENDENCE & AWARENESS

[Instructions: Read this chapter prior to coming to your next group. Answer the questions the chapter before coming to group. In group, you will simply share what your answers were and participate in a brief question/answer discussion held by the group facilitator. *If you do not want to share this chapter in group, let the group facilitator know prior to the meeting. He/she will make other arrangements with you.*

Untangling ourselves from negative relationships can be a difficult and tiring process. Many people never succeed in doing it. As a person learns truths about what they can and cannot control in relationships, their awareness tends to grow. Developing complete awareness of your relationships is the goal of this chapter.

I. Drawing Your Relationships

1. In the space below, draw a picture of yourself in the center using less than half the space. Don't worry about your drawing ability, you may draw a "stick person" if you like.
2. Next, draw a picture (stick people are okay) of all the important people in your life. Try to show how "close" these people are to you by drawing each person nearby or far from you. You might draw family members around you, friends close-by, and others based on your relationship with them. You should take care to avoid identifying these people by name. Remember to not share anything in group you don't want others to know.
3. Next, identify any people who are a real help to you. These people consistently make your life easier and more enjoyable, they help you solve problems. Draw a circle around each of these.
4. Finally, identify the people who make your life more difficult. These people create problems and usually will be out of your control. Draw a box around them. In group, you will be asked to show your drawing.



II. Questions On Relationships

1. How many people did you draw boxes around on the prior page? 2

2. Based on the definitions of codependence we have given you, how many of these (boxed) relationships are codependent? [Codependence is an attempt to control uncontrollable situations; Codependence is a pattern of negative behaviors developed because of a relationship; Codependence is a lack of trust; Codependence is self-sacrifice.]

I don't try to sacrifice for any of these people to change their situation.

3. Looking at the codependent relationships you identified on the prior page, list below the answers to this question: What are you doing for these people that they should be doing for themselves?

I don't do things for these people they should be doing for themselves. I help when asked and only if I have the capacity to help.

4. What feelings have you **not** expressed to these people?

To the boxed people, none. I tell them when I am done, or when I can't help and they should do their own things.

5. Are any of these people doing things for you that you should be doing for yourself?

If you have filled out this chapter before group and successfully shared your responses with the group, you will be asked to move on to the next chapter.